

AIST Movie DVSuite 4.0

Inexpensive, but complex

Movie DVSuite 4.0 is part of the MovieX family of video-editing tools. It comes with a complete video editing suite, a PCI DV capture card with four FireWire ports and a FireWire cable. There is also some third party software—Sonic MyDVD, which lets you create DVDs; and a 30-day trial of Movie3D.

Installation was a breeze. The main workspace has many sub-components, the most important of these being the Timeline, browser window, work window, the effect box and the preview window.

The timeline has four video and two audio tracks, and make the task of inserting and editing frames very simple. Apart from this, Movie DVSuite also has a storyboard mode that makes importing

clips and inserting transitions a snap.

While the software packs a punch as far as features are concerned, it does take a beating on the usability front. The interface is complex, and the user has to spend time getting used to it. This aside, it does provide some detailed video editing features.

Professional video editors can consider this product as a cheaper option, but they will find Adobe Premiere or Ulead MediaStudio more feature-rich and useful.

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Intel Pentium II 400 MHz or higher; Windows 98SE, 2000, ME, 2000; also, Windows NT 4.0 with SP 6 if FireWire not used, 64 MB RAM, 8 GB hard disk space for video production; display card with OpenGL support; SoundBlaster compatible sound card

Price: Rs 3,500
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Web site: www.aist.com

AIST Movie DVSuite 4.0		A-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

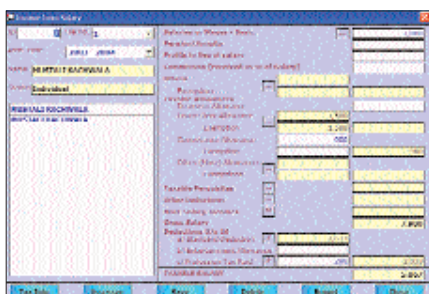
CompTax

Computing Income Tax Made Easy

CompTax is targeted at small to medium accounting firms. Two useful features are calculation of advance and self-assessment

taxes, and calculation of interest payable U/s 234A, 234B and 234C. It also enables reverse tax calculation, thereby helping the user prepare a tax plan.

The software needs specific technical inputs at quite a few locations throughout the package. Apart from these, it is simple to use. The interface is very simple. One aspect that's lacking



is that it does not allow you to modify the Standard Deductions Details, thus entangling you to update the package each year as the laws change.

It is priced at Rs 3,250, which in itself is a good price; but if you need to update each year and pay a Rs 1,500, it's not a good option. The company provides no free updates; at the same time, it doesn't provide any services free of cost. You need to pay service charges, travel charges

Price: Rs 3,250 (Upgrade Cost Rs 1,500)
Contact: Relyon Softech Ltd
Phone: 080-3354600
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Web site: www.relyonsoft.com

and daily allowances.

The final question that needs to be asked is, after you buy this product, can you save more money in tax than the price of the software, or the cost of the update every year?

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Hardware: Pentium 100 MHz or higher; 32 MB RAM; 50 MB free hard disk space
Software: Microsoft Windows 95, 98, Me, NT, 2000, XP; Internet Explorer 5 or Later; Office 97 or Later

CompTax		B-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of Use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Kodak LS633 Digital Camera

Light on battery, great on performance

Kodak is the first digital camera manufacturer to integrate an Organic LED display into a camera. OLEDs save a lot of power, as they don't need to be backlit.

The LS633 is a 3.11 mega-pixel camera with 3x optical zoom. The camera has 5 pre-defined modes, so you can take pictures with ease. It also has a manual override facility for prolonged exposure. The icon-based menu is intuitive; and browsing is straight forward with the joystick.

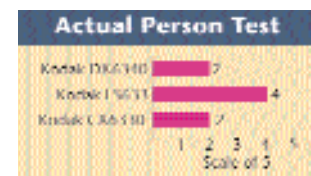
The camera returned decent images, and didn't produce dark pictures with the Auto setting—which most cameras struggle to do. Colours were reproduced precisely, and it picked up the details very clearly, making it good choice for those who are into product photography.

Its 37-111 Schneider-Kreuznach Variogon optical zoom lens did well in our



Zoom test. The image was a little grainy because of the 3.3x digital zoom, but this happens with more expensive cameras as well.

The LS633 is a good buy, and at a cost of Rs 29,900 with the bundled Li-Ion rechargeable batteries, has low running costs too.



SPECIFICATIONS

3.1 mega-pixel, 3x optical zoom, 3.3x digital zoom, OLED display and Li-Ion battery

Price: Rs 29,900
Contact: Neoteric Informatique
Phone: 022-2417 2600
E-mail: rajeev@neoteric-info.com
Web site: www.kodak.com

Kodak LS633 Digital Camera		B
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶	